Medical foods for a diagnosis of inborn errors of metabolism (IEM)

Inborn errors of metabolism are rare genetic (inherited) disorders in which the body cannot properly turn food into energy. The disorders are usually caused by defects in specific proteins (enzymes) that help break down (metabolize) parts of food. G.E.H.A will cover medical food for a diagnosis of IEM. Medical Food is defined as a food which is recommended by a physician after an evaluation and is intended to provide for the dietary management of a disease or condition that has specific nutritional requirements. G.E.H.A will not cover "grocery" food items that can routinely be obtained online or in stores (e.g., gluten-free breads).

Medical necessity

Healthcare services, drugs, supplies or equipment provided by a hospital or covered provider of the healthcare services for the purpose of preventing, evaluating, diagnosing, or treating a medical or behavioral health condition, that the Plan determines are all of the following:

- Are appropriate to diagnose or treat the patient's condition, illness or injury in terms of type, frequency, extent, site and duration of treatment, and treatment setting are considered effective for your condition;
- Are consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice in the United States.
  - Generally accepted standards of medical practice are based on credible scientific evidence published in peer-reviewed medical literature generally recognized by the relevant medical community, national physician specialty society recommendations and the views of medical practitioners practicing in relevant clinical areas, and any other relevant factors. Please refer to geha.com/Coverage-Criteria for details on the literature used in medical decision making;
- Are not primarily for the personal comfort or convenience of the patient, the family, or the provider;
- Are not a part of or associated with the scholastic education or vocational training of the patient;
- Are not more costly than an alternate drug, service(s), or supply that is at least as likely to produce equivalent therapeutic or diagnostic results for the diagnosis or treatment of your condition;
- In the case of inpatient care, cannot be provided safely as observation or on an outpatient basis;
- Is not custodial or long-term care (see the Plan's definition).

The fact that a covered provider has prescribed, recommended, or approved a service, supply, drug or equipment does not, in itself, make it medically necessary. We reserve the right to consult expert opinion in determining whether healthcare services are Medically Necessary.

Medicare Part A

Part A helps cover inpatient hospital stays, skilled nursing facility care, hospice care, and some home health care.

Medicare Part B

Part B covers medically necessary services like doctors' services and tests, outpatient care, home health services, durable medical equipment, and other medical services.

Medicare Part C

Part C is a Medicare Advantage plan that combines the coverage of Medicare Part A and Part B. Part C typically also covers additional benefits like dental, vision, and hearing services. Some Part C plans also include Medicare Part D coverage.

Medicare Part D

Medicare Part D plans provide coverage for prescription drugs. Private insurers contract with CMS on an annual basis for the right to offer Part D plans. Part D can be offered as a standalone Prescription Drug Plan (PDP) or as part of a Medicare Advantage Prescription Drug Plan (MAPD).